Ben Brook

GAME & LEVEL DESIGNER

CONTACT

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Los Angeles · open to remote

DESIGN

Level & mission design

Quest & narrative design

Combat encounters & enemy design

Pacing & spatial flow

Systemic mechanics

VR interaction & haptics

Live ops

TECHNICAL

Unreal Engine 5 & 4

Blueprint visual scripting

AI behavior trees & navigation

World Partition & streaming

Profiling & optimization

Python scripting

TOOLS

Perforce · SVN · Jira · Confluence

Miro · Figma · Illustrator

Maya · 3ds Max

EDUCATION

BFA, Interactive Design & Game Development

Savannah College of Art and Design · 2017–2020

COMMUNITY

Mentor, Always Supporting the Games Community (ASGC)

Game Designer leading level and quest design for Global MapleStory Classic World at Nexon. Since 2022 I've built levels across AAA, live ops, and VR, balancing art, gameplay, and narrative to create spaces that feel believable and fun to play in.

EXPERIENCE

Game Designer

JUN 2026 – PRESENT

Nexon America · MapleStory Classic World

- Built Forgotten Hollow, a new region for levels 39–59 launching November 18, after its initial concept: dozens of quests, most of its 26 maps, NPCs, items, and monster placement.
- Designed the live Caretaker's Ledger questline, with a hidden map, three new NPCs, quest items, and an earrings reward.
- Set rewards for the Henesys and Kerning City citizenship questlines and retuned quest EXP across Victoria Island before launch.
- Supported both launches with collision, quest, and text fixes (about 300 commits in five months).

Level Designer

AUG 2024 – AUG 2025

Cloud Chamber (2K) · BioShock 4 (unannounced)

- Owned core narrative missions on the Living World strike team, from paper design and blockout through Alpha in Unreal Engine 5.
- Defined critical-path pacing, objectives, AI combat encounters, and layouts.
- Scripted bespoke gameplay moments and interaction chains in Blueprints, reducing engineering overhead.
- Led Art, Audio, and Narrative partners through data-informed iteration and late-stage polish.

Gameplay / Level Designer

MAR 2023 – AUG 2024

Skydance Games · Skydance's Behemoth (PS VR2, Quest, PC VR) · Project Lonestar

- Concepted Behemoth's final area, the setting for the climactic fight that closes the campaign.
- Designed the opening chapter's castle hub: a grand entryway onto a courtyard built around a central arch landmark, connecting to two further areas.
- Built VR melee combat spaces and physics-based interactions in Unreal Engine 5.
- Took the hub of an unannounced Walking Dead VR title (courthouse, police station, and connecting tunnel) from paper maps to a playable UE5 vertical slice.

Game / Level Designer

JAN 2022 – MAR 2023

Skydance Games · The Walking Dead: Saints & Sinners – Chapter 2: Retribution

- Designed, concepted, tested and implemented every new weapon and attachment (chainsaw, sawed-off shotgun, SMG, grenade launcher, silencers, laser sights) with art, audio, and animation; rebalanced the assault rifle and 9mm pistol.
- Designed the Eradicator and Tower Grenadier enemies from spec through Blueprint implementation and playtest tuning.
- Designed and tuned every chainsaw haptic curve across PS VR2, Quest and PC VR.
- Specced Night Mode's dead-body loot, rebuilt Tower Mission 2 around Exile Orders, and built every Exile camp.

Lead Gameplay Designer

2020 – 2021

SCAD Games Studio · Zoélie

- Owned core mechanics, the 3Cs, and puzzle design on a 39-person team for a combat-free 3D puzzle platformer.
- Won Best Gameplay, 1st place, at the 2021 Intel University Games Showcase.

PERSONAL & JAM PROJECTS

Sumo Scuffle · solo iOS party game, rebuilt from a SCAD prototype into a commercial release (2026) · **Hell, My Name Is Buba** · Epic MegaJam 2021 · **Beepo & Pogo** · GMTK 2021